

## CHAPTER 1

## The Productivity Myth

# The AI Productivity System

There is a secret that productivity gurus will not tell you: working harder is not the answer. Students who hustle 18 hours a day burn out. Students who optimize their 8 focused hours outperform them. The difference is not effort — it is leverage.

### Automate Tasks, Manage Time &

Productivity in the AI age is not about doing more things. It is about doing the right things with less friction. It is about building systems that handle the repetitive, the boring, and the time-consuming — so you can focus on what actually moves the needle.

This is not about becoming a robot. It is about creating more time for the things that matter: learning deeply, building relationships, pursuing creative projects, and yes, occasionally doing absolutely nothing.

Join Roy

## The Three Productivity Traps

1. The Busyness Trap. Feeling productive because you are always busy. Busy is not the same as effective. Answering 50 emails is busy. Completing your most important project is effective.
2. The Optimization Trap. Spending more time organizing your productivity system than actually using it. The perfect Notion setup that takes 20 hours

to build and is never used again.

3. The Tool Trap. Believing the next app will solve your productivity problems. Todoist, Notion, Obsidian, motion, Sunsama — the tool does not matter as much as the habit.

#### □ KEY CONCEPT

The goal of productivity is not to maximize output. It is to create space for what matters. If your "productivity system" leaves you exhausted and joyless, it is not working.

## CHAPTER 2

# The AI-Aware Brain

AI fundamentally changes what it means to be "productive." Tasks that used to require significant time and skill — writing, research, data analysis, scheduling, design — can now be done in a fraction of the time. The key is knowing what to offload and what to keep.

### The Offload-Own Framework

| Offload to AI (delegate)               | Own Yourself (do manually)             |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Formatting and editing                 | Strategic thinking and decision-making |
| Research and summarization             | Original analysis and conclusions      |
| Scheduling and reminders               | Building relationships                 |
| Data processing and visualization      | Creative direction and taste           |
| Repetitive writing (emails, templates) | Personal communication that matters    |
| Transcription and note-taking          | Deep reading and understanding         |

The principle: if a task repeats and follows rules, AI can own it. If it requires judgment, creativity, or human connection, you should own it. AI handles the predictable; you handle the meaningful.



## CHAPTER 3



# Daily Systems

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Motivation is unreliable. Systems are not. This chapter gives you a daily workflow that makes productivity the default — not something you have to fight for each morning.

## The AI Command Center

Create a single "command center" — a document, Notion page, or app where you interact with AI for your daily planning:

1. Morning check-in (5 min): "Here are my tasks for today: [list]. Here is my energy level: [high/medium/low]. What should I prioritize? Suggest a time block schedule."
2. During deep work (as needed): "I am stuck on [specific problem]. Give me three possible approaches without writing the full solution."
3. Evening review (5 min): "Here is what I accomplished: [list]. Here is what slipped: [list]. What should I do differently tomorrow?"

## DAILY PLANNER PROMPT

It is [time] on [day]. Here is my task list:  
[list tasks]

My top 3 priorities are: [list]  
I have [hours] of focused time available.

Create a time-block schedule for my day. Include:

- Deep work blocks (90 min max)
- Break reminders (every 90 min)
- Email/message batch times
- End-of-day review time

## CHAPTER 4

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# Automating the Boring Stuff

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Every student has tasks that are necessary but mind-numbing. Email responses, meeting notes, data entry, formatting, file organization. AI can automate or dramatically speed up all of these.

### Top 10 Student Automation Wins

1. Email drafting: "Draft a professional email to [professor/classmate] asking [request]. Polite but direct."
2. Meeting notes: "Summarize these meeting notes and extract action items: [paste notes]."
3. Bibliography formatting: "Format these sources in APA 7th edition: [paste sources]."
4. Flashcard generation: "Create 20 Anki flashcards from these notes: [paste]."
5. Schedule coordination: "I need to find a time that works for [number] people. Their availability is [list]. Suggest optimal times."
6. Template creation: "Create a weekly report template based on this structure: [describe]."
7. Data cleaning: "This dataset has [issue]. Write Python/Excel code to clean it. [paste data or describe]."
8. Citation checking: "Review this paper and flag any claims that need citations: [paste text]."

9. Social media scheduling: "Draft one week of social media posts based on [content themes]."
10. Group project coordination: "Create a project plan for [project]. Team size: [N]. Deadline: [date]. Deliverables: [list]."



## CHAPTER 5

# Focus in the Age of Distraction

The average student checks their phone 96 times per day. That is once every 10 minutes. Every notification is a context switch, and each switch costs 23 minutes of refocus time. This chapter gives you strategies to protect your attention.

## The Deep Work Protocol

1. Time block your deep work. Schedule 2-3 blocks of 60-90 minutes for your most cognitively demanding tasks. Treat these like non-negotiable appointments.
2. Eliminate the phone. During deep work, your phone goes in another room. Not on silent. Not face down. In another room.
3. Use AI as a focus guard. "I am about to start a 90-minute deep work session on [task]. If I message you during this time with a question, do not answer it — remind me to stay focused."
4. Batch shallow work. Email, messages, social media — handle these in 2-3 designated blocks, not continuously throughout the day.

### ▮ PRO TIP

The most productive students do not have more willpower. They have fewer distractions. Design your environment so focus is the path of least resistance.

## CHAPTER 6



# Weekly Reviews and Planning

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Without regular review, even the best systems decay. The weekly review is the habit that keeps everything else working. It takes 30-45 minutes and pays for itself tenfold.

## The 30-Minute Weekly Review

1. Clear your inboxes (10 min). Process all emails, messages, and notes to zero. Archive what is done. Action what needs action. Delete the rest.
2. Review last week (5 min). What was completed? What slipped? Why?
3. Preview this week (10 min). What are your top 3 priorities? What are the fixed commitments (classes, meetings)? Where are the gaps?
4. Plan with AI (5 min). "My week looks like [overview]. My top priorities are [list]. Create a suggested schedule."

## WEEKLY PLANNING PROMPT

It is Sunday evening. Help me plan my week.

Last week:

Completed: [list]

Not completed: [list]

This week:

Fixed commitments: [list classes/meetings]

Top 3 priorities: [list]

Personal goals: [list]

Create a balanced daily schedule that accounts for study, assignments, self-care, and rest.

# CHAPTER 7

## Building Sustainable Habits

A productivity system you abandon in two weeks is worse than no system at all. The final chapter is about building habits that last — not just this semester, but for your entire career.

### The Compound Effect

Small improvements compound dramatically:

| Daily Improvement                    | After 1 Year                       |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1% better per day                    | 37x better                         |
| 30 min extra deep work per day       | 182 extra hours per year           |
| 5 min evening review per day         | 30 extra hours of clarity per year |
| 1 fewer hour of social media per day | 365 hours reclaimed per year       |

You do not need to overhaul your life. You need to make small, consistent improvements. AI can help you identify which small changes will have the biggest impact.

## □ ACTION STEP

Start with ONE change this week. Master it. Then add another. The student who builds one habit per month will be unstoppable by graduation.

*"We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence, then, is not an act, but a habit. — Aristotle"*

You now have a complete system for AI-powered productivity. The frameworks, tools, prompts, and habits in this book will serve you for years. But systems are useless without action. Pick one chapter and implement it this week. Then come back for the next one.

— Joy Roy, Founder of Aryvora

## WORKBOOK & EXERCISES

# Put It Into Practice

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### Exercise 1: Map Your Time

Track how you actually spend your time for 3 days. Identify your top 3 time-wasters.

#### Your Turn

Day 1: Hours on deep work: \_\_\_\_ Hours on shallow work: \_\_\_\_ Hours wasted: \_\_\_\_  
Day 2: Hours on deep work: \_\_\_\_ Hours on shallow work: \_\_\_\_ Hours wasted: \_\_\_\_  
Day 3: Hours on deep work: \_\_\_\_ Hours on shallow work: \_\_\_\_ Hours wasted: \_\_\_\_  
Top 3 time wasters: 1. 2. 3.

### Exercise 2: Build Your Command Center

Create your AI command center — the document or page where you interact with AI for daily planning.

#### Your Turn

Tool used: \_\_\_\_\_ Link/location: \_\_\_\_\_ Morning check-in prompt: \_\_\_\_\_  
Evening review prompt: \_\_\_\_\_ I tested it for one day. It worked: Y/N What I will improve: \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 3: The Deep Work Experiment

Schedule one 90-minute deep work block for tomorrow. Follow the Deep Work Protocol. Report results.

### Your Turn

Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Task: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone location during session: \_\_\_\_\_  
Distractions that occurred: \_\_\_\_\_ Quality of output (1-10): \_\_\_\_\_  
How I felt after: \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 4: Run Your First Weekly Review

This Sunday, complete the 30-Minute Weekly Review process.

### Your Turn

Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Time spent: \_\_\_\_\_ Last week completed: \_\_\_\_\_  
Last week not completed + why: \_\_\_\_\_ This week top 3 priorities: 1. \_\_\_\_\_  
2. \_\_\_\_\_ 3. \_\_\_\_\_ AI schedule suggestions (paste): \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 5: Build Your Automation List

Identify 5 tasks you will automate or AI-assist starting next week.

### Your Turn

Task 1: \_\_\_\_\_ How AI will help: \_\_\_\_\_ Task 2: \_\_\_\_\_ How AI will help: \_\_\_\_\_  
Task 3: \_\_\_\_\_ How AI will help: \_\_\_\_\_ Task 4: \_\_\_\_\_ How AI will help: \_\_\_\_\_  
Task 5: \_\_\_\_\_ How AI will help: \_\_\_\_\_



## PROMPT LIBRARY



# Ready-to-Use Prompts

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### Daily Planner

Plan my day. Tasks: [list]. Energy level: [high/medium/low]. Available hours: [number]. Create a time-blocked schedule with deep work blocks, breaks, and shallow work batches.

### Weekly Review

Help me review my week. Completed: [list]. Not completed: [list]. Challenges: [list]. Suggest 3 improvements for next week and help me plan Monday.

### Focus Guard

I am entering a deep work session for [duration] on [task]. If I send you messages during this time, remind me to stay focused and do not give me information until the session ends.

### Email Batch Processor

Here are my unread emails: [list subjects/senders]. Categorize each as: (1) respond now, (2) schedule response, (3) archive, (4) needs more info. Draft responses for the "respond now" items.

### Habit Tracker Setup

I want to build these habits: [list]. Help me design a simple tracking system. Suggest the smallest possible daily action for each habit and a weekly reward.

### Procrastination Buster

I have been procrastinating on [task]. Help me: (1) identify why I am avoiding it, (2) break it into the smallest possible first step, (3) give me a 5-minute starting ritual.

### Meeting Summarizer

Summarize this meeting and extract action items: [paste notes/transcript]. Format: key decisions, action items (with owners and deadlines), and open questions.

### Template Generator

Create a reusable template for [type of document/task] that I can customize. Include placeholders in [brackets], suggested formatting, and tips for each section.

### Energy Optimizer

Here is my weekly schedule: [describe]. Here is when I have the most energy: [times]. Help me rearrange my schedule to match high-energy times with high-priority tasks.

### Automation Finder

I spend too much time on [describe routine tasks]. Which of these could be automated with AI tools? For each, suggest a specific tool and a prompt to automate it.

## QUICK REFERENCE

# Cheat Sheet

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- Productivity = doing the right things, not doing more things
- Offload to AI: repetitive, rule-based tasks. Own: judgment, creativity, connection
- Daily: morning check-in, deep work blocks, evening review
- Phone goes in another room during deep work — not on silent, IN ANOTHER ROOM
- Weekly review: 30 minutes, Sunday evening, process + preview + plan
- Batch shallow work — email and messages in 2-3 designated blocks
- Start with ONE new habit, master it, then add another
- 1% better per day = 37x better per year
- Environment design > willpower for maintaining focus
- Systems beat motivation every time

### Pro Tip

Print this page and keep it at your desk while you work.